Persona 1: The Busy High School Student

- **Age:** 17
- **Occupation or student status:** High School Senior & Part-Time Job Worker
- **Goals:** Wants to cook quick, healthy meals after a long day of classes and extracurriculars without spending extra money or wasting groceries.
- **Challenges:** Frequently finds random leftover ingredients in the fridge but lacks the culinary confidence or time to figure out what to make, leading to food waste and unnecessary takeout spending.
- **How my app would help them:** The **Fridge Snap** feature allows them to take a quick photo of their remaining fridge items to instantly generate easy, zero-waste recipes, saving them both time and money.
- **One quote that represents how they feel:** *"I'm always exhausted after practice, and looking at a random assortment of leftovers just makes me want to order expensive takeout instead."*

Persona 2: The Independent College-Bound Teen

- **Age:** 18
- **Occupation or student status:** Incoming College Freshman
- **Goals:** Wants to learn basic cooking skills, master independent living, and stick strictly to a tight grocery budget.
- **Challenges:** Has limited cooking experience, easily gets overwhelmed by complex recipes, and struggles to make ingredients last before they spoil.
- **How my app would help them:** The **Pantry Expiry Tracker** alerts them before food goes bad, while the **Substitution Finder** and step-by-step guidance help build their cooking confidence using whatever items they have on hand.
- **One quote that represents how they feel:** *"I want to cook real meals for myself in my dorm kitchen, but I'm terrified of wasting money on ingredients I don't know how to use."*

Persona 3: The Budget-Conscious Home Cook

- **Age:** 24
- **Occupation or student status:** Entry-Level Graphic Designer
- **Goals:** Wants to cut down on monthly household grocery expenses, eat healthier, and minimize environmental food waste.
- **Challenges:** Tries to plan meals weekly, but inevitably ends up with forgotten vegetables and half-used condiments expiring in the back of the pantry.
- **How my app would help them:** The **Green Impact Dashboard** tracks money saved and food waste prevented over time, and the **Zero-Waste Recipe Builder** turns random pantry staples into creative meals.
- **One quote that represents how they feel:** *"It breaks my heart to throw away spoiled groceries every week, but I never seem to plan my meals efficiently enough to use everything up."*